

INDIA'S ESPORTS PROFESSOR

ON TURNING GAMING PASSION INTO A
STRUCTURED INDUSTRY

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AKSHAT RATHEE
Co-Founder and Managing
Director, NODWIN GAMING

It's easy to mistake Indian esports for a collection of flashy tournaments, viral highlights, and sporadic bursts of buzz. But Akshat Rathee, Co-founder and Managing Director of NODWIN Gaming has been trying to give it structure, sustainability, and real-world relevance for the better part of a decade and more.

For an industry that's been largely event-led, his argument is that structure – not scale alone – will define whether India's esports ascent is a blip or a blueprint.

Over the years, Rathee's journey has been as eclectic as it has been relentless: from engineer and management consultant to building one of South Asia's biggest esports engines, and then expanding into entertainment IPs such as Comic Con India and NH7 Weekender while connecting Indian esports to global stages.

In an exclusive interview, Rathee gets candid on where Indian esports stands, where it's headed, and how an entire generation can find legitimate careers in the process.